

Clayworks: Building Workspaces That Give Back



Rahul Singh & Abhijith Shashidhar
Co-Founders & Directors of Clayworks

In a sector defined by glass towers and energy-hungry HVAC, Clayworks is rewriting what a premium workspace owes to the planet.

When commercial real estate talks sustainability, it usually stops at a green certificate framed in the lobby. At Clayworks, the Benagluru-headquartered premium workspace brand with over 17 centres and more than 350 member brands, sustainability was never meant to be a plaque on the wall. It is wired into how the company designs, builds, powers and operates, a conviction captured in its philosophy, Humansense at Work, and recognised with multiple 'Most Sustainable Office' awards in recent years.

"Sustainability is our operating system. If a decision is good for our members but bad for the planet, it isn't a Clayworks decision," says Abhijith Shashidhar, Co-Founder. Clayworks' most powerful sustainability principle is also its most counterintuitive. Rather than break ground on new construction, the company actively champions the adaptive reuse of existing spaces. "The most sustainable square foot is the one we never had to build. Reusing what already exists is the single biggest carbon decision we make," he adds.

Design that Works With Nature

Every centre begins with passive design that maximises daylight, reducing artificial lighting by 20 percent, while natural ventilation and glazing keep interiors cool. Biophilic design improves member wellbeing and lowers the energy load. "We design for the human first and the planet always," says Shashidhar.

They use low emission paints, reclaimed wood, recycled furniture and locally sourced materials. Commissioning finishes from Indian artisans encourages local craft practices, shortens supply chains, and raises awareness about vanishing traditions. "Choosing an Indian artisan over an imported finish is good for the carbon math and good for the community," says Shashidhar.

Heart At The Right Place

For every workstation it creates, Clayworks plants a tree. To date, under 'One Seat, One Tree' initiative, the company has planted around 7,500 trees in Chikmagalur. "As the business grows, so does the forest, and we intend to grow our bamboo forest to over 500 acres. Our Design & Build business is proof that

clients no longer see sustainability and profitability as trade-offs, they expect both" says Rahul Singh, Co-Founder.

Also, with 5.6 MW of installed solar capacity meeting roughly 85 percent of its electricity needs, the company avoids 6,000 tonnes of CO₂ annually. Beyond design and energy, Clayworks closes the loop with zero-to-landfill waste segregation and EV-ready infrastructure. A growing share of its members are enterprises with strong sustainability mandates that see their workspace as an extension of their values. "Increasingly, our members aren't just renting space, they're choosing alignment," says Singh. Clayworks intends to have carbon-neutral operations, 100 percent renewable energy and net-positive centres by 2035. "Our members are building the future of Indian business. The least we can do is make their spaces worthy of that future," concludes Shashidhar.

